



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Geneva Academy

School Website: <https://www.genevaacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Geneva Academy in Bellefontaine, Ohio presents a clearly Christian, covenantal, classical educational frame grounded in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and sobriety about forming character—virtue, wisdom, and love of learning—through a Bible-centered paideia. Website content emphasizes partnership with parents, a discipleship-oriented pedagogy, and a Christ-centered worldview integrated across the curriculum. Evidence shows strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and a purposeful emphasis on formation over mere information, with explicit statements about Scripture, Coram Deo, and a covenantal relationship with families. However, explicit, public commitments to Great Books, a fully interdisciplinary Great Conversation, or high-school-level Socratic seminars are not clearly stated on the site, which slightly limits the Curriculum and Pedagogy marks. The school also foregrounds parental involvement and community partnership. Overall, Geneva Academy aligns with many classical elements, but the public materials do not consistently demonstrate all six elements at a fully Classical level. Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights:

- Religious and metaphysical framing is central and explicit (Christ-centered, covenantal, Scriptural integration, Coram Deo) and is well supported by published mission/philosophy statements.
- The curriculum is clearly Trivium-based (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and asserts classical aims, but explicit mention of Great Books and Great Conversation is not evident in public pages. This yields a partial Classical alignment.
- Pedagogy is anchored in classical methods (rhetoric, memory, disciplined inquiry) though direct statements about Socratic seminars or full upper-school debates are not explicit in the site copy.
- Faculty philosophy centers on teacher quality and commitment, with explicit emphasis on formation and long-term relationships; however, phrases like “living curriculum” or a highly stylized faculty portrait are not directly visible in the captured pages.
- Parents and community involvement are clearly identified as core, with explicit language about partnering with families and honoring parental authority in paideia.

ABSTRACT

takeaway: Geneva Academy shows strong Classical orientation in religious foundations, formation goals, and Trivium-based curriculum, with notable strength in parent partnership and covenantal emphasis. The missing or ambiguous signals around Great Books/Great Conversation and certain high-school pedagogy keep the overall classification at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- Public materials present a Christian, covenantal framework: “Education that is Classical, Christian, and Covenantal” and overall mission to “cultivate students of wisdom and virtue to the glory of God.”
- Explicit theological language and Scriptural grounding are woven through the philosophy, including references to Coram Deo and Scripture-integrated pedagogy.
- Statement of Faith and covenantal partnership with families underscore the religious-metaphysical foundation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Christ-centered, Christian, covenantal, Scriptural integration, Coram Deo, paideia, discipleship, theology. These terms align with the Positive Keywords cluster for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (theology/scripture, liturgical framing, coram Deo, virtue as transcendentals). The site uses explicit phrases such as “Christ-centered,” “Scriptures,” and “Coram Deo.”
- Negative indicators: None materially evident in public pages (no explicit relativism, secularism, or value-neutral framing observed).

Why this rating

- The school publicly anchors itself in a Christian, covenantal paideia and integrates Scripture throughout curriculum, with a theology-inflected metaphysical frame that maps well to the classical model’s religious foundation signals. This combination justifies CLASSICAL signals in this category, given the weight of explicit Christian metaphysical grounding. However, because the site does not demonstrate liturgical practices or a broader liturgical–communal discipline beyond church affiliation, the rating is placed at CLASSICAL in spirit but treated as a strong CLASSICAL signal rather than a perfect liturgical-structural claim. The practical outcome: CLASSICAL signals are strong, with room for more explicit liturgical articulation.

Citations: Geneva Academy’s stated aims and philosophy (Education that is Classical, Christian, and Covenantal), Our Mission, and By Christian we mean sections provide the core evidence.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- The mission emphasizes cultivation of wisdom and virtue for God’s glory, i.e., formation over information and the aim of human excellence.
- The philosophy describes formation of character through a classical education, aligning with scholé/-contemplation and lifelong formation of the mind and affections.
- The explicit Christian framework and paideia orientation frame the telos as contemplating truth, goodness, and beauty as transpersonal ideals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, transcendence of truth/goodness/beauty, paideia, scholé (educational restfulness), great conversation references in classical literature context. The site uses formation language (“cultivate students of wisdom and virtue”), virtue language, and a teleological aim consistent with classical education philosophy.
- Negative indicators: No explicit modern workforce- or job-readiness framing, which would indicate a move away from classical telos. The site does not foreground career-technical aims.

Why this rating



- The clear emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the real-true-good-beauty telos supports CLASSICAL in this category. The mission explicitly rejects a purely utilitarian or information-transfer aim. Therefore, Element 2 is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Our Mission and Educational Philosophy content showing formation and telos.

Element 3: School Curriculum — [CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- The curriculum is framed around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a core liberal-arts framework of classical education. The site describes the grammar/logic/rhetoric progression and aims of forming the ability to learn.
- The public materials emphasize “Classical education” with a focus on learning how to learn and a Christ-centered, covenantal approach.
- Explicit references to Great Books or the Great Conversation are not clearly present in the public pages, and the page does not consistently frame history as a core across the curriculum in the same way as some classical schools. (Great Books/Great Conversation signals are strong in the knowledge-base but not explicitly documented on the Geneva site in the captured pages.)

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), classical education, discipline of rational inquiry, Christian integration of learning, the three-stage developmental framework aligned to grammar/logic/rhetoric. These map to Positive Keywords for Curriculum (Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium, rhetoric, grammar, logic).
- Negative indicators present: Lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation on public pages; lack of explicit, site-wide history-as-social-studies framing and cross-disciplinary Great Books references (no clear “Great Books” or “Great Conversation” on the site copy). This aligns with the negative signals in the knowledge-base for missing Great Books/Great Conversation signals.

Why this rating

- The presence of the Trivium and explicit Classical framing supports a CLASSICAL rating, but the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and broad Great Books engagement on the public site lowers it toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Therefore Element 3 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Trivium description and Classical framing on site; absence of explicit Great Books references on public pages.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- The Trivium-based pedagogy implies a transition from grammar (memory/recitation) to logic (dialectic) and rhetoric (persuasive expression). The site explicitly describes the Trivium and its stages.
- The site references a discipleship-oriented, integration-focused approach with an emphasis on forming affections and moral development, which aligns with contemplative/restful elements and formation.
- Specific public statements about Socratic seminars, upper-school debates, or formal school-wide scholé days are not explicitly present in the captured site copy. The public materials emphasize the Trivium and formation more than detailed class-structure pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Socratic-style inquiry and seminars are not explicitly stated; however, rhetoric and disciplined inquiry are present; emphasis on “how to learn” and “pursuit of truth.” The Greek/Latin classical pedagogy signals (grammar/logic/rhetoric) map to Positive Keywords around pedagogy (Socratic, dialectic, rhetoric, memory work, recitation).
- Negative indicators: Explicit, public evidence of regular Socratic instruction, seminars, or the full high-school-scale Socratic pedagogy is not demonstrated in the captured content. The absence of those explicit signals can push toward a weaker Classical signal in this category.

Why this rating

- The core pedagogy is classical (Trivium and formation). Without explicit evidence of regular Socratic seminars or extensive student-led, inquiry-driven seminars, this category remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Pedagogical signals from Trivium-focused content.

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- The site emphasizes teacher quality and the commitment to forming students with virtue; there is explicit pride in professional, mature faculty with long-term commitments.
- The mission expresses that teachers are expected to be skilled in classical education and to embody virtue, with a sense of “living curriculum” implied by the formation focus and the covenantal partnership with families.
- There is public discussion about state certification and training in classical pedagogy (e.g., “State Certified Teachers” page and related posts) which shows a professional, pedagogically grounded faculty framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum (conceptually present in the language about teachers forming students and being the core of the school), collegial/sacred ethos with families, long-term commitment to the school.
- Negative indicators: The exact phrasing “portrait of a teacher” or formal “faculty portraits” is not visible in the captured copy, though the described teacher commitments imply that dimension. The explicit phrasing of “the living curriculum” is not directly quoted, albeit conceptually supported.

Why this rating

- Given the strong emphasis on teachers as moral exemplars and the school’s commitment to classical pedagogy with professional development, Element 5 trends toward CLASSICAL, but the lack of explicit public, direct quotes about a formal “living curriculum portrait” tempers it to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Our Mission and faculty-formative language; “State Certified Teachers” and related posts.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — [CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- The school explicitly positions itself as partnering with parents and teaches that parents are co-teachers in the paideia. It highlights partnerships with families and the primacy of parental involvement.
- The statements about a Covenant with families, and the claim that parents must be part of the Christian home context, underscore parental leadership and education in classical terms.

- Public-facing content notes families from various churches, indicating an inclusive but theologically framed parent community; it also states they welcome visits and involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Partnership with families, co-teaching role for parents, parental formation resources, openness to family involvement, and welcoming campus visits. These map to Positive Keywords in the Parents and Community section (parent partnership, co-educators, household formation, family involvement, school-parent synergy, open campus). The site evidences most of these signals in the public pages cited above.
- Negative indicators: None evident in the public materials; the site's stance is pro-parent partnership rather than consumer-like parental withdrawal.

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly support CLASSICAL signals in this category due to clear emphasis on parent partnership, formation in the home, and a covenant with the family. Element 6 is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Partnering with parents language and Statement of Faith page; open-campus language.

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicitly publish a Great Books/Great Conversation framework as a school-wide curricular strand, including representative titles and cross-subject integration, to elevate Element 3 to Classical.
 - Publicly articulate a clear plan for upper-school pedagogy that includes Socratic seminars, seminars, or Harkness-style discussions in the high school grades to strengthen Element 4.
 - Publicly document a more explicit "living curriculum" portrait of faculty and a formalized teacher development program to strengthen Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.
 - Expand public-facing evidence of liturgical or communal practices beyond a covenantal/Christian framework, to strengthen Element 1's liturgical signal (without compromising the existing covenantal basis).
-

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.